Slop / University

Cleared to Skip, Stopped Anyway

Auditing When Intercampus Shuttle Drivers Override an Arrival-Forecasting Model

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Background

Slop University's intercampus shuttle skips a stop whenever its arrival-forecasting model logs the stop as empty. Drivers increasingly stop anyway. Does the override catch riders the model's sensors miss, or just add unscheduled minutes to a service built to remove them?

Aims

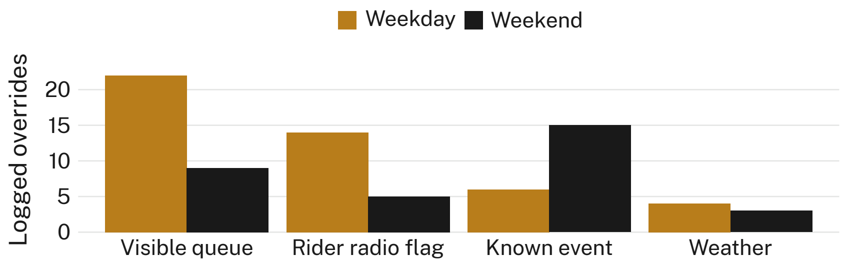
- Quantify how often drivers override the model's skip call
- Catalogue the reasons drivers give for overriding it
- Test whether those reasons shift between weekday and weekend schedules

Methods

- 8 weeks, both loops · 210 scheduled skip calls reviewed against dispatch logs
- Post-shift structured interviews with 11 drivers · reasons coded to a 4-category taxonomy
- Taxonomy fixed before log review; no category added after week 2

Results

Drivers overrode the model's skip call on 78 of 210 reviewed stops. A visible queue is the leading reason on both schedules, though its weekday share nearly triples the weekend one.



Drivers cited a visible queue for the override nearly three times as often on weekdays as on weekends (22 of 46 vs 9 of 32 logged overrides, Mar–Jun 2026); a known event nearby drove the weekend total instead.

Discussion & conclusions

An override rate above one in three implies the model's stop-side sensing, or its threshold, is missing more than the induction loop was built to miss. The reasons cluster by schedule, not by driver. Next: instrument the stop itself, not just the vehicle.

References

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Dispatch-log review conducted under the shuttle operator's standing data-sharing agreement; driver interviews de-identified by shift, not by name.